

Document 4: Seasonal Allergic Rhinitis (Hay Fever)

Metadata

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Definition of Seasonal Allergic Rhinitis

Seasonal allergic rhinitis, commonly known as hay fever, is an allergic reaction to outdoor airborne allergens, most commonly pollen from trees, grasses, and weeds, or mold spores.

Symptoms of Seasonal Allergic Rhinitis

Symptoms trigger immediately upon exposure to the allergen and include:

- Repeated sneezing
- Runny nose with clear, watery discharge
- Itchy, watery, or red eyes (allergic conjunctivitis)
- Itchy nose, roof of mouth, or throat
- Postnasal drip leading to a mild cough

Treatment and Management for Seasonal Allergic Rhinitis

The primary strategy is allergen avoidance. Medical management includes:

- **Antihistamines:** OTC or prescription medications (e.g., cetirizine, loratadine) to reduce itching, sneezing, and runny nose.
- **Nasal Corticosteroids:** Prescription or OTC nasal sprays (e.g., fluticasone) are the most effective treatment for reducing nasal inflammation and congestion.
- **Decongestants:** For short-term relief of severe nasal stuffiness.

When to Seek Medical Attention for Allergies

A doctor should be consulted for allergies if:

- Allergy symptoms are severely impacting sleep or daily activities.
- OTC medications are ineffective or cause intolerable side effects.
- The patient has concurrent asthma and experiences wheezing or shortness of breath.